Windows DNS Server Remote Code Execution Vulnerability

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CVE-2026-69730
Security Vulnerability

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Released: Sep 8, 2026

Assigning CNA
Microsoft

CVE.org link
CVE-2026-69730

Impact
Remote Code Execution

Max Severity
Critical

Weakness
CWE-416: Use After Free

CVSS Source
Microsoft

Release date Descending

Vector String
CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H/E:U/RL:O/RC:C

Metrics
CVSS:3.1 9.8 / 8.5 ⓘ Base score metrics: 9.8 / Temporal score metrics: 8.5

Expand all Collapse all

Metric	Value
Base score metrics (8)	
Attack Vector This metric reflects the context by which vulnerability exploitation is possible. The Base Score increases the more remote (logically, and physically) an attacker can be in order to exploit the vulnerable component.	Network The vulnerable component is bound to the network stack and the set of possible attackers extends beyond the other options listed, up to and including the entire Internet. Such a vulnerability is often termed 'remotely exploitable' and can be thought of as an attack being exploitable at the protocol level one or more network hops away (e.g., across one or more routers).
Attack Complexity This metric describes the conditions beyond the attacker's control that must exist in order to exploit the vulnerability. Such conditions may require the collection of more information about the target or computational exceptions. The assessment of this metric excludes any requirements for user interaction in order to exploit the vulnerability. If a specific configuration is required for an attack to succeed, the Base metrics should be scored assuming the vulnerable component is in that configuration.	Low Specialized access conditions or extenuating circumstances do not exist. An attacker can expect repeatable success against the vulnerable component.
Privileges Required This metric describes the level of privileges an attacker must possess before successfully exploiting the vulnerability.	None The attacker is unauthorized prior to attack, and therefore does not require any access to settings or files to carry out an attack.
User Interaction This metric captures the requirement for a user, other than the attacker, to participate in the successful compromise the vulnerable component. This metric determines whether the vulnerability can be exploited solely at the will of the attacker, or whether a separate user (or user-initiated process) must participate in some manner.	None The vulnerable system can be exploited without any interaction from any user.
Scope Does a successful attack impact a component other than the vulnerable component? If so, the Base Score increases and the Confidentiality, Integrity and Authentication metrics should be scored relative to the impacted component.	Unchanged An exploited vulnerability can only affect resources managed by the same security authority. In this case, the vulnerable component and the impacted component are either the same, or both are managed by the same security authority.
Confidentiality This metric measures the impact to the confidentiality of the information resources managed by a software component due to a successfully exploited vulnerability. Confidentiality refers to limiting information access and disclosure to only authorized users, as well as preventing access by, or disclosure to, unauthorized ones.	High There is total loss of confidentiality, resulting in all resources within the impacted component being divulged to the attacker. Alternatively, access to only some restricted information is obtained, but the disclosed information presents a direct, serious impact.
Integrity This metric measures the impact to integrity of a successfully exploited vulnerability. Integrity refers to the trustworthiness and veracity of information.	High There is a total loss of integrity, or a complete loss of protection. For example, the attacker is able to modify any/all files protected by the impacted component. Alternatively, only some files can be modified, but malicious modification would present a direct, serious consequence to the impacted component.
Availability This metric measures the impact to the availability of the impacted component resulting from a successfully exploited vulnerability. It refers to the loss of availability of the impacted component itself, such as a networked service (e.g., web, database, email). Since availability refers to the accessibility of information resources, attacks that consume network bandwidth, processor cycles, or disk space all impact the availability of an impacted component.	High There is total loss of availability, resulting in the attacker being able to fully deny access to resources in the impacted component; this loss is either sustained (while the attacker continues to deliver the attack) or persistent (the condition persists even after the attack has completed). Alternatively, the attacker has the ability to deny some availability, but the loss of availability presents a direct, serious consequence to the impacted component (e.g., the attacker cannot disrupt existing connections, but can prevent new connections; the attacker can repeatedly exploit a vulnerability that, in each instance of a successful attack, leaks a only small amount of memory, but after repeated exploitation causes a service to become completely unavailable).
Temporal score metrics (3)	
Exploit Code Maturity This metric measures the likelihood of the vulnerability being attacked, and is typically based on the current state of exploit techniques, public availability of exploit code, or active, 'in-the-wild' exploitation.	Unproven No publicly available exploit code is available, or an exploit is theoretical.
Remediation Level The Remediation Level of a vulnerability is an important factor for prioritization. The typical vulnerability is unpatched when initially published. Workarounds or hotfixes may offer interim remediation until an official patch or upgrade is issued. Each of these respective stages adjusts the temporal score downwards, reflecting the decreasing urgency as remediation becomes final.	Official Fix A complete vendor solution is available. Either the vendor has issued an official patch, or an upgrade is available.
Report Confidence This metric measures the degree of confidence in the existence of the vulnerability and the credibility of the known technical details. Sometimes only the existence of vulnerabilities are publicized, but without specific details. For example, an impact may be recognized as undesirable, but the root cause may not be known. The vulnerability may later be corroborated by research which suggests where the vulnerability may lie, though the research may not be certain. Finally, a vulnerability may be confirmed through acknowledgement by the author or vendor of the affected technology. The urgency of a vulnerability is higher when a vulnerability is known to exist with certainty. This metric also suggests the level of technical knowledge available to would-be attackers.	Confirmed Detailed reports exist, or functional reproduction is possible (functional exploits may provide this). Source code is available to independently verify the assertions of the research, or the author or vendor of the affected code has confirmed the presence of the vulnerability.

Please see Common Vulnerability Scoring System for more information on the definition of these metrics.

Executive Summary Use after free in Windows DNS allows an unauthorized attacker to execute code over a network.

Exploitability

The following table provides an exploitability assessment for this vulnerability at the time of original publication.

Publicly disclosed
No
Exploited
No
Exploitability assessment
Exploitation More Likely

FAQ

How could an attacker exploit this vulnerability?

An unauthenticated attacker could exploit this vulnerability by sending a specially crafted packet to an affected service over the network. Successful exploitation could allow the attacker to execute code on the target system. No authentication or user interaction is required.

Acknowledgements

Souhail Hammou (@dark_puzzle) Microsoft recognizes the efforts of those in the security community who help us protect customers through coordinated vulnerability disclosure. See Acknowledgements for more information.

Security Updates

To determine the support lifecycle for your software, see the Microsoft Support Lifecycle.

Edit columns | Download | Filters

Keyword | Product Family | Max Severity | Impact | Platform

Clear

Release date ↓	Product	Platform	Impact	Max Severity	Article	Download	Build Number	Assigning CNA
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2025	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122871	Security Update	10.0.26100.33438	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows 10 Version 1607 for 32-bit Systems	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123099	Security Update	10.0.14393.9512	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2012 R2	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123066	Monthly Rollup	6.3.9600.23398	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2012 (Server Core installation)	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123065	Monthly Rollup	6.2.9200.26349	Microsoft

version	revisionDate	description
1.0	Sep 8, 2026	Information published.

Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2012	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123065	Monthly Rollup	6.2.9200.26349	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2016	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123099	Security Update	10.0.14393.9512	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2016 (Server Core installation)	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5123099	Security Update	10.0.14393.9512	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2022 (Server Core installation)	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122882	Security Update	10.0.20348.5622	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2022	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122882	Security Update	10.0.20348.5622	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2019 (Server Core installation)	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122876	Security Update	10.0.17763.9245	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows 10 Version 1809 for x64-based Systems	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122876	Security Update	10.0.17763.9245	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows Server 2019	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122876	Security Update	10.0.17763.9245	Microsoft
Sep 8, 2026	Windows 10 Version 1809 for 32-bit Systems	-	Remote Code Execution	Critical	5122876	Security Update	10.0.17763.9245	Microsoft

Broken | Bad | Below average | Average | Great!